

****Be Careful Who Uses AI to Find Their Soulmate****

The Algorithm is Mercenary

Tinder, Grindr, and all other dating apps increasingly use artificial intelligence to match hearts in search. It is not a good idea to let an algorithm get to know our emotions and our most intimate desires so well.

****Intervention by Guido Scorza, Member of the Guarantor for the Protection of Personal Data****

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“If we hadn’t done it, someone else would have, and if you’re not the first to arrive in the artificial intelligence market, you risk falling behind.” This was George Arison’s response, CEO of Grindr, the most popular online dating site in the world dedicated to the LGBT+ community, when asked why he decided, so early and despite the evident risks, particularly regarding privacy, to integrate artificial intelligence algorithms into his service to help users find their soulmate or companionship for an evening, generate emotionally personalized responses, or suggest venues, music, atmosphere, and words for a first date.

And the problem with artificial intelligence, which progressively conquers even the most personal aspects of our lives, is exactly this. The protagonists of digital markets perfectly understand the “first mover” rule: the first to arrive conquers the market and leaves nothing for the second and third. Therefore, there is no time to wait, no time to assess the impact of resorting to certain differently intelligent solutions, no time to ask whether the game is worth the candle, if, for example, in a case like this, having a better chance of capturing a partner’s attention justifies the enormous amount of personal data – even those related to our emotional, sentimental, and sexual sphere – surrendered to voracious artificial intelligence algorithms.

And aside from privacy, there is also no time to evaluate whether it really makes sense and whether it produces humanly and ethically sustainable results to be helped by an algorithm in winning over our soulmate, suggesting words that, perhaps, we would never have written or presenting ourselves as, in reality, we are not.

But the market commands, or at least, that’s how it seems. Indeed, in the online dating market, it appears that there is already no one who can escape the use of artificial intelligence. Tinder, the most popular dating app in the world, is on the same path as Grindr. Algorithms are already available to its users to help them create profiles with which they have better chances of conquest and to help them write irresistible messages that guarantee the most coveted conquests.

A study by AttractionTruth published by Decrypt reports that, even today, 20% of men using dating apps use integrated or non-integrated artificial intelligence solutions – ChatGPT Love would be one of the most popular – and that 40% of them would be ready to swear that thanks to algorithms their sex appeal and conquests have skyrocketed.

And this widespread perception – which, to be honest, seems to have little scientific basis when it comes to matters of the heart and attraction – only exacerbates the problem or, at least, the challenge we face because, naturally, it will be tough to convince the hundreds of millions of users worldwide who use dating apps not to reject the support of a differently intelligent friend to achieve more success but, at least, to do so guided by common sense, reflection, and consideration, evaluating whether it is truly worth putting so much of oneself in the hands of algorithm factories just to see – perhaps – the probability of choosing the right words to break the ice or the right place for a first date increase.

And if on the other side there were – as is starting to happen – someone who uses the same differently intelligent friends to be suggested how much is natural and how much is artificial in the person on the other side? What impression would that make? The impression of someone who, to find their soulmate or simply a companion for a carefree evening, needs the help of a robot? Because, of course, algorithms are mercenaries and can be allies of the new artificial Latin lovers as well as their fiercest enemies capable of literally exposing them to the eyes of the most coveted conquests.

But aside from bad impressions, it really is not a good idea to let an algorithm – whoever is behind it – get to know our emotions, our most intimate desires, and our hearts so well because we are truly unable to know how the company controlling it will use such precious knowledge, but we do know for certain that when someone gets to know us so well, they are in a position to compress, limit, and manipulate our freedom of choice in various areas and directions.